Yoorim Son

M.A. Student in Economics | Sogang University | Seoul, Korea

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Homepage | GitHub

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Development economics; applied microeconomics; digital infrastructure; local economic development and spatial inequality; geospatial and satellite-based economic measurement.

EDUCATION

Sogang University, Seoul, Korea

Mar 2025 - Present | Expected graduation: 2027

M.A. in Economics | Advisor: Hyunjoo Yang

Hankuk University of Foreign Studies, Yongin, Korea

Mar 2017 - Feb 2021

B.A. in South African Languages and Cultures

Minor in Political Science and Diplomacy

University of Botswana, Gaborone, Botswana

Jan 2018 - May 2018

Visiting / Exchange Student | Coursework in Political Science

WORKING PAPERS

Mobile Broadband Upgrading and Spatial Inequality in South Africa

With Hyunjoo Yang | October 2026

- Follows South Africa's 2021-2024 spectrum transition using quarterly Ookla measurements, comparing municipalities by initial quality, baseline poverty, and regulatory priority.
- Documents narrowing low-speed and relative-speed disadvantages alongside widening absolute speed gaps. Separate exploratory poverty comparisons examine high-speed expansion, with inference and measurement-coverage qualifications.

Where Do International Connectivity Gains Arrive?

Draft

Spatial Broadband Upgrading and Employment after Equiano in South Africa

- Combines municipal broadband measurements, sectoral administrative employment data, spatial measures, and satellite-derived controls to study post-2023 spatial adjustment.
- Examines spatial broadband gradients using fixed effects, event studies, and synthetic-control diagnostics, with explicit limits on causal attribution.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Sogang Spatial Economics & AI Lab

Apr 2026 - Present | Sogang University

Research Group Member (Master's Student) | Lab Head: Hyunjoo Yang

- Contribute to agricultural prediction using machine learning and spatial data within a lab working on geospatial data, economics, and Korea's development.
- Collected and constructed maize and rice ground-truth datasets; completed the rice sampling workflow and am constructing XGBoost features to predict cultivated area across Asian countries.

MIRACLE: Subnational Economic Data for South Korea, 1960-1989

Nov 2025 - Present | Research Associate

Project Leads: BooKang Seol, Changkeun Lee, and Hyunjoo Yang

- Contribute to a consistent township-year economic panel using municipal statistical yearbooks and archival records, with geographic identifiers spanning administrative boundary changes.
- Completed administrative-region data collection and coordinated a five-person collection team.
- Currently work on OCR-based extraction and processing of historical statistical records.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026 Korean Economic Review (KER) International Conference

June 22, 2026 | Halla Convention Center, Jeju, South Korea

The Economic Impact of Submarine Cable Arrival on Local Economic Activity: Evidence from South Africa

With Hyunjoo Yang | Presenter | Contributed Session A5: Empirical Microeconomics

PLANNED COLLABORATION

Satellite-Based Measurement of North Korean Economic Activity

Upcoming | Bank of Korea

Planned collaboration using satellite data to estimate industrial production and develop measures of economic activity where conventional statistics are limited.

METHODS & DATA

Programming: Python.

Empirical methods: Fixed effects, event studies, spatial exposure designs, synthetic-control diagnostics; training in difference-in-differences and instrumental variables.

Machine learning: XGBoost, sampling, and feature construction.

Data: Panel and administrative data, broadband performance, GIS and satellite-derived measures, historical archives, crop ground-truth data, and OCR workflows.

LANGUAGES

Korean: Native | English: Intermediate (academic reading and writing).